

6th Grade Band Syllabus

Mrs. Deeann Nishibun • SY 2026-2027

Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder.

2026-2027 Essential Question

"With Jesus, what makes my spirit soar?"

Mrs. Deeann Nishibun

Band Director • Grade 6 • Mary, Star of the Sea School

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Emails are read/replied to during regular school hours.

Course Outline & Objectives • Grade 6

Throughout the school year, students will learn the value of music by understanding the elements of music: rhythm, dynamics, melody, harmony, tone color, and texture. By the end of the year, all students will demonstrate proper posture, playing position, intonation, fingerings, style, balance and blending, articulation, and phrasing.

Students will use this knowledge and the fundamentals of their instrument to actively listen, express themselves, and engage through music. Music Education allows students to develop a love of music that will carry on for the rest of their lives.

6th Grade Scope & Sequence

6th Grade			
Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
MUSIC LITERACY Deals with the signs and symbols that constitute written music. The decoding, understanding, and use of these symbols develop the ability to read, write, and perform music.	MUSIC MAKING Requires guided participation in various group sizes in a variety of musical activities such as singing, playing instruments, and musical movement. Participation will develop intelligent and musically sensitive performers.	RESPONDING TO MUSIC Promotes the development of skills in listening, describing, analyzing, and evaluating music that will foster a personal response justified through musical criteria.	MUSIC AND CULTURE Promotes a broad historical and cultural perspective, and an understanding of the importance of music in the lives of individuals and societies throughout history.

6th grade students can play a woodwind, brass, or percussion instrument. The band program provides a more focused and structured approach to music education, emphasizing peer performance and ensemble skills. Band programs provide students the opportunity to develop important skills such as teamwork, responsibility, dedication, and their individual musicianship skills. The program also provides opportunities for students to showcase their skills in a small public setting, which can build confidence and self-esteem. Our band program is designed to provide students with a more in-depth and hands-on musical education on their instrument of choice, which can lead to a

lifelong love and appreciation of music.

Required Materials

All students are required to have the following in their possession at every class session:

- Essential Elements Method Book 1
- Assigned Instrument (Percussionists will bring book and their own drumsticks to class)
- Instrument Accessories — 3 extra reeds, valve oil, mouthpiece, cork grease, neck strap, slide cream, cleaning cloth, polishing cloth

Failure to bring the required materials will result in reduced participation points for that class.

Student Behavior

Students are expected to:

- Respect all people and property in the classroom at all times.
- Participate in all activities and come prepared for every class.
- Try their best.
- Follow the student code of conduct per the handbook.

If expectations are not met, we will take steps to help students reflect and improve:

- Gentle verbal reminders to support making better choices.
- Time during recess or lunch to review expectations and practice positive habits.
- A conversation with parents via email or phone to partner in success.
- A meeting with the principal to create a plan for moving forward.

Grading Policy

Students earn grades through class participation, testing, and weekly at-home practice. Students needing extra help may schedule a meeting during recess or lunch. All assignments are posted on Google Classroom — 6th Band. All grades are posted in Beehively, which includes late and missing assignments. Students and parents should check Google Classroom and Beehively frequently.

Class Participation

50%

- Bringing instrument and book to every class
- Bringing all other required materials
- Following rules and directions
- Active participation

Testing

30%

- Playing and written tests

- Weekly practice is necessary to review and remember fingerings and concepts learned during class. Practicing several times a week with shorter sessions is recommended to achieve the 60-minute weekly total (example: 4x a week for 15 minutes each).
- The log must include a parent/guardian signature to receive full credit.
- Due by 5:00 pm every Friday on Google Classroom.
- Late logs receive partial credit; logs will not be accepted 7 days past the due date.

Contact Information

Email: dnishibun@starofthesea.org

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Empowered to Succeed, Guided by Faith